

CTF Challenge: “The Anomalous Network”

Category: Misc

Points: 300

Flag Format: `l8xieee{...}`

Description

Your team is monitoring a corporate network when the security dashboard suddenly lights up with **strange activity**.

Multiple servers are reporting unusual traffic, but the logs are scrambled and incomplete. It looks like someone left a subtle “signature” in the data. Your task is to **identify the compromised host** and deduce the **reset code** hidden in the logs.

Network Activity Log (excerpt):

Host	Port	Packets	Status
192.168.1.2	80	120	OK
192.168.1.5	443	0	OK
192.168.1.7	22	312	ALERT
192.168.1.9	3389	0	OK
192.168.1.12	21	7	OK

Additional Observations:

- The **host ID** of the compromised server is always **prime**.
 - The **packet count** contains the number of vowels in the hostname spelled out as digits.
 - The **flag** is formatted as `l8xieee{HostID_PacketCode}`.
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Hints

1. Identify which host triggered the **ALERT**.
2. Check if the **host ID (last octet)** is prime.

3. Calculate the **packet code** using the vowel rule.
 4. Combine them for the flag.
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Solution

1. **Alerting host:** 192.168.1.7 → last octet = 7 (prime ✓)
2. **Vowels in hostname spelled out as digits:** “one nine two dot one six eight dot one dot seven” → count vowels:
 - one → o,e → 2
 - nine → i,e → 2
 - two → o → 1
 - one → o,e → 2
 - six → i → 1
 - eight → e,i → 2
 - one → o,e → 2
 - seven → e,e → 2**Total vowels = 14 → PacketCode = 14**
3. **Combine:** `l8xieee{7_14}`